
Four Nations,
One Identity

Map Trap: how many countries can you find?



Look at the map. Work with a partner: how many countries do you think make up the United Kingdom?

Now imagine saying to someone from Edinburgh: “So, you are English!” Why might they be offended?

UK, Great Britain, or England?



England

One country.



Great Britain

England, Scotland, and Wales.



The United Kingdom

Great Britain and Northern Ireland.

Do not use “England” when you mean the whole UK.

Four nations, four capitals



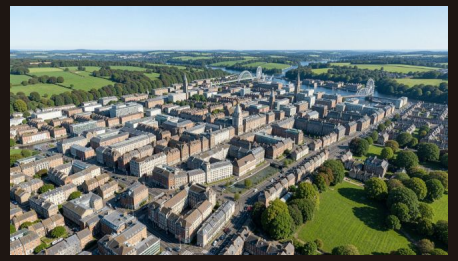
England

London



Scotland

Edinburgh



Wales

Cardiff



Northern Ireland

Belfast

What might the title “Four Nations, One Identity” mean?

Key words for today

1. Devolution
2. Sovereign

A. The qualities, beliefs, and culture that make a group different.

B. A country that is part of a larger political union.

3. Constituent country
4. Identity

C. The process of transferring power from a central government to regional governments.

D. Having supreme power or authority.

Match each word with its definition. Then check with a partner.

While viewing: listen for the details

Watch the video and complete the table.

FIRST VIEWING

Find the capitals.

SECOND VIEWING

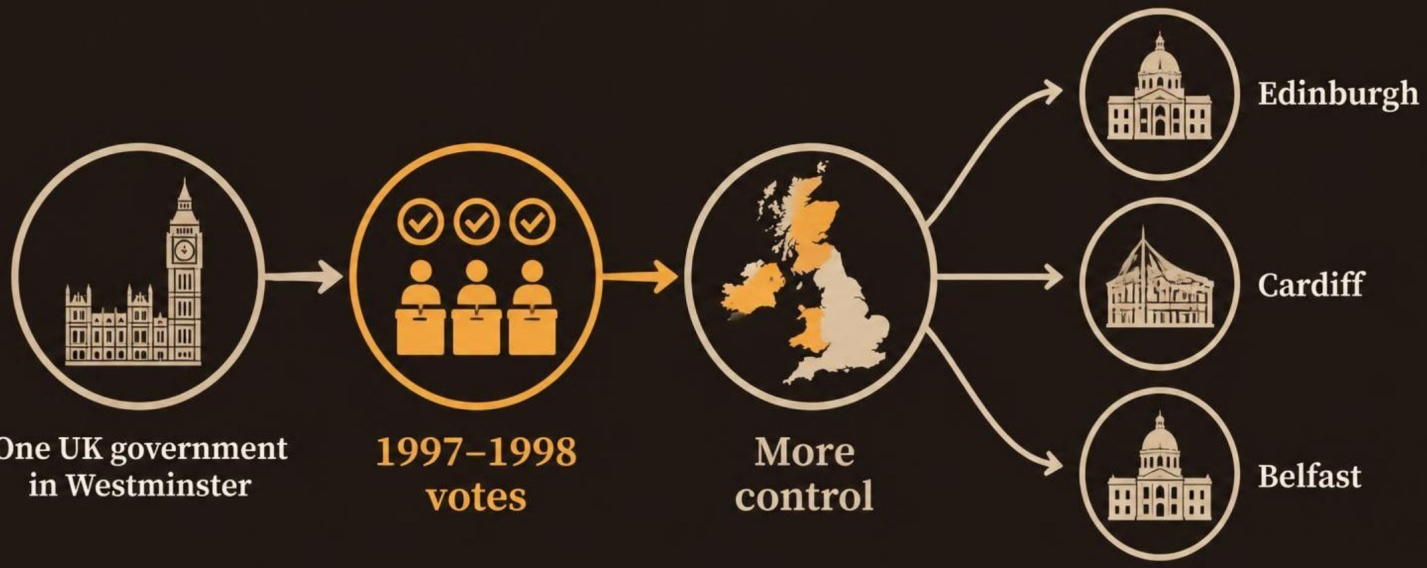
Check the parliaments.

Country	Capital	Own parliament?
		Yes / No
		Yes / No
		Yes / No
		Yes / No

What is devolution?

For many years, the four nations were run by one UK government in Westminster, London.

In 1997 and 1998, people in Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland voted for more control over decisions in their nations.



Who decides what?

DEVOLVED POWERS

Regional governments

- Education
- Housing
- The environment
- Health

RESERVED POWERS

UK government

- Foreign affairs
- Defence
- International relations
- Economic policy

Important: the nations do not all have exactly the same powers.

In your own words: why did the UK government give more power to local parliaments?

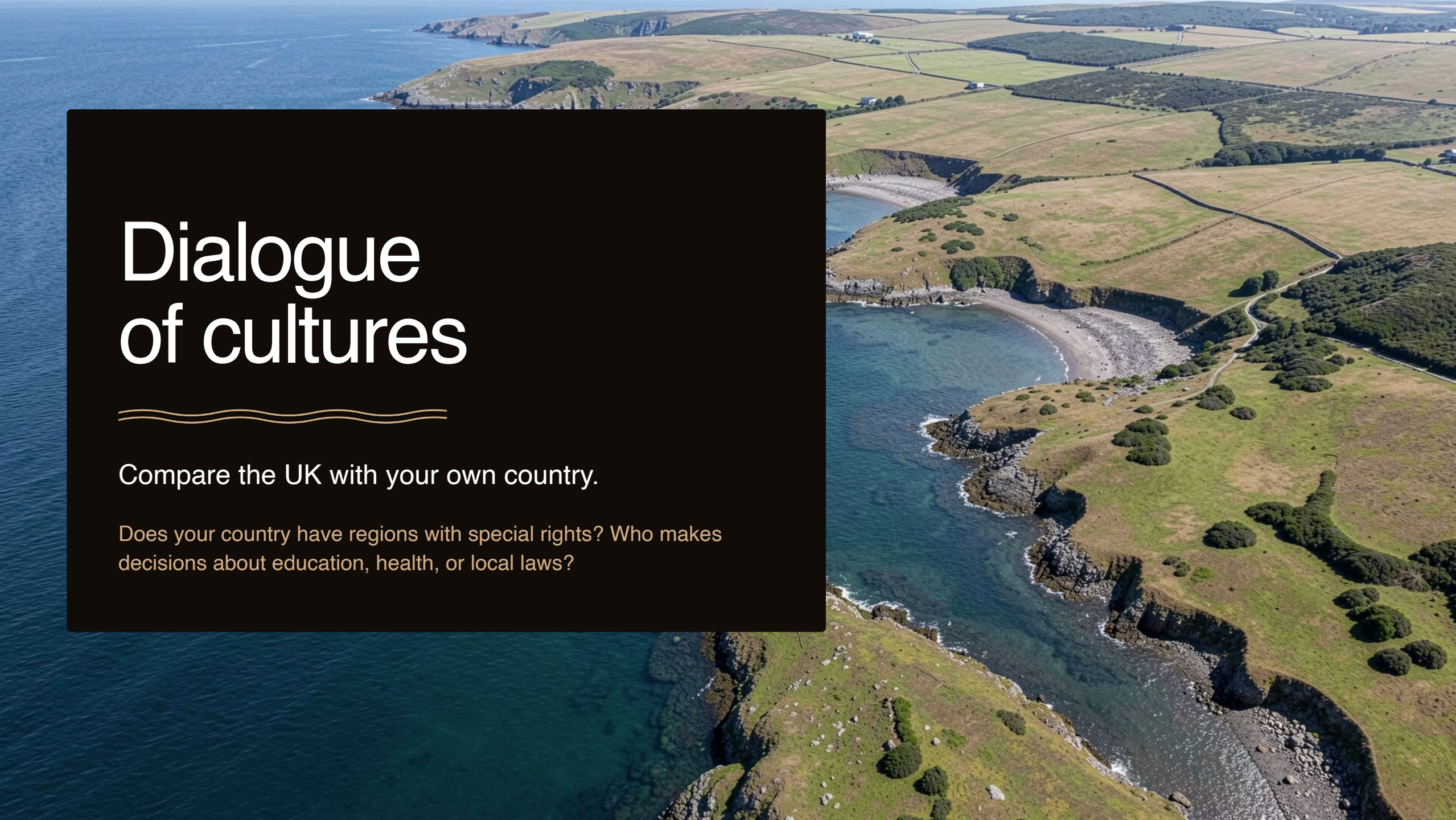


Tourist Survival Guide

You work for a UK travel agency. In a group, write four rules for tourists so they do not offend anyone.

1. Use the correct national identity.
2. Use the right name for a country or the UK.
3. Check what “English” means before you use it.
4. Explain one respectful alternative.

Example: Do not call a person from Scotland “English”. Say “Scottish” or “British”.



Dialogue of cultures

Compare the UK with your own country.

Does your country have regions with special rights? Who makes decisions about education, health, or local laws?